Police protect their own

"Union" contracts allow police to purge misconduct records, reinstate fired officers, limit oversight, and block investigations into uses of violence. [1] Media, jurors, and prosecutors are often biased in favor of police narratives. [2]

Bias training doesn't work

Hundreds ofstudies datingback to the 1930s show that anti-bias training doesn't alter behavior or change the workplace. [3]

Police don't care about reforms

Bodycams (even when on) haven't reduced civilian complaints, uses of force, or significantly altered judicial outcomes. [4] A choke-hold ban has not protected numerous Louisiana residents from police brutality.

why not REFORM?

policing DOESN'T WORK!

"First, repeated analysis has consistently failed to find any connection between the number of police officers and crime rates. Second, the primary strategies adopted by modern police have been shown to have little or no effect on crime." [5]

Only 5% of arrests are for the most serious offenses, including murder, rape, and aggravated assault. [6] Three quarters of crime reduction is attributable to factors other than incarceration. [7]

Homeless sweeps make the problem worse

Arresting unhoused people and destroying their possessions makes it harder for them to access the services they need for medical care and stable housing. [8]

Domestic violence aid groups caution against calling police

Many victims face increased violence from their partner following police encounters. [9] Victims are rarely given the help they need. [10]

Police are ineffective and cause harm to our communites. Poor and minority communites are more directly affected by police violence.

DEFUND THE POLICE!

a better world is possible

Together we can make it real.

Baton Rouge Democratic Socialists of America are organizing to *fund* your community. This is only possible with your help. Visit **brdsa.org** to learn more.

design and sources from: sv-dsa.org/defund

DEFUND the police...

start funding communities!

Cities are spending millions of dollars on policing. Imagine what else we could spend that on:

Education

Studies show "schooling significantly reduces the probability of incarceration and arrest." [10]

Supportive housing

An effective way to help unhoused neighbors. [11]

Community accountability and restorative justice

Community-based alternatives to policing and incarceration or other punishment-based systems. [12]